



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

REBUILDING is underway in Altadena after an astonishing eight-month federal cleanup after the fires.

With fire cleanup complete, concerns over speed vs. safety

Some residents fear job was rushed and will cost them later

By Tony Briscoe, Noah Haggerty and Sandhya Kambhampati

The devastation left in the wake of January’s Eaton and Palisades fires was unimaginable. The firestorms engulfed 59 square miles of Southern California — more than twice the size of Manhattan — transforming entire city blocks in Altadena and Pacific Palisades into corridors of ashes, twisted metal and skeletal trees.

Federal disaster officials rapidly deployed thousands of workers to gather up the wreckage across the burn scars. Armed with shovels and

heavy construction equipment, crews quickly collected fire debris from rugged cliffsides, dusky shorelines and sprawling burnt-out neighborhoods. In a matter of months, they transformed the heaps of charred rubble into mostly vacant matchbox lots, ready for rebuilding.

Recently, the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers reported that it had finished clearing roughly 2.6 million tons of wreckage from nearly 9,700 properties, an astonishing eight-month fed-

eral cleanup that has been extolled as the largest and fastest in modern American history. Private contractors removed fire debris from an additional 2,100 parcels.

However, many experts worry that the rapid pace of federal cleanup resulted in sloppy work, time-saving measures and lax oversight that may ultimately cost homeowners.

The Army Corps has largely demobilized and contractors have cleared

[See Cleanup, A6]

How one man caught in raid got home

The lights never dimmed and Angel Minguela Palacios couldn’t sleep. He pulled what felt like a large sheet of aluminum foil over his head, but couldn’t adjust to lying on a concrete floor and using his tennis shoes as a pillow.

He could smell unwashed bodies in the cramped room he shared with 40 detainees. He listened as men, many of them arrested at car washes or outside Home Depots, cried in the night for their loved ones.

Minguela, 48, lay in the chilly downtown Los Angeles ICE facility known as B-18 and thought about his partner of eight years and their three children. In his 10 years in the United States, he had built a secure life he had only dreamed of in Mexico, ensconced in their humble

While in ICE lockup, a strawberry delivery man kept mind on family

By Brittny Mejia



CARLIN STEIHL Los Angeles Times

ANGEL Minguela Palacios arrives home to his son and wife. He was detained while at work last month.

one-bedroom rented home, framed photos of the family at Christmas, his “#1 Dad” figurine. Now it was all falling apart.

The morning of Aug. 14, Minguela had been on his last delivery of the day, dropping off strawberries to a tearoom in Little Tokyo. He didn’t know that Gov. Gavin Newsom was holding a news conference there to inveigh against President Trump’s efforts to maintain control of the U.S. House of Representatives through redistricting in Texas. U.S. Border Patrol agents were massing nearby, creating a show of force outside the event.

As they moved in, one agent narrowed in on Minguela’s delivery van. Soon, he was in handcuffs.

[See Detention, A14]

Three Western allies recognize Palestinian state

Announcement by the U.K., Australia and Canada angers Israel’s Netanyahu.

By PAN PYLAS

LONDON — The U.K., Australia and Canada formally recognized a Palestinian state on Sunday, prompting an angry response from Israel, which ruled out the prospect.

The coordinated initiative from the Commonwealth nations and longtime allies of Israel, announced on the eve of the annual U.N. General Assembly gathering, reflects growing outrage at Israel’s conduct of the war in Gaza and the steps taken by the Israeli government to thwart any efforts to create a Palestinian state, including by the continued expansion of settlements in the West Bank.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer, who has faced pressure to take a harder line on Israel within his gov-

erning Labor Party, said his nation’s move is intended “to revive the hope of peace for the Palestinians and Israelis.” But he insisted that it wasn’t a reward for Hamas, which rules Gaza and is designated a terrorist group by the U.K. and the U.S.

“Today, to revive the hope of peace and a two-state solution, I state clearly as prime minister of this great country that the United Kingdom formally recognizes the state of Palestine,” Starmer said in his video message. “We recognized the state of Israel more than 75 years ago as a homeland for the Jewish people. Today we join over 150 countries who recognize a Palestinian state also. A pledge to the Palestinian and Israeli people that there can be a better future.”

The moves by the three countries prompted Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to say that the establishment of a Palestinian state “will not happen,” while Hamas urged the international community to

[See Mideast, A3]

ICE raids surge, LAPD calls sink

Deportation fears may deter reports of domestic violence and other crimes.

By LIBOR JANY AND HAILEY WANG

At the same time that federal immigration enforcement ramped up across the Los Angeles area this summer, calls for help to local police plummeted.

Emergency dispatch data reviewed by The Times show a major decrease in LAPD calls for service in June, during the weeks when sweeps by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and other federal agencies were met by large protests in downtown Los Angeles.

In a city where roughly a

third of the population is foreign-born, the steep decline in calls adds to long-standing concerns from advocates that aggressive immigration enforcement leads to domestic abuse and other crimes going unreported because victims fear triggering deportations.

In the two weeks after June 6, when the immigration raids kicked off, LAPD calls for service fell 28% compared with the same period last year — an average of roughly 1,200 fewer calls per day.

LAPD officers responded to roughly 44,000 calls for service in that two-week span — versus nearly 61,000 calls during the same days in June 2024.

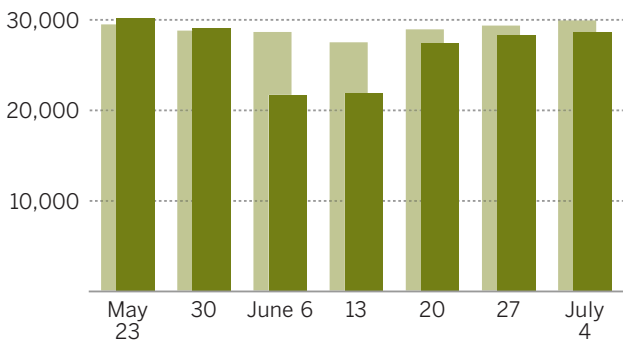
The calls include reports of serious crimes, such as home break-ins and domes-

[See LAPD, A5]

LAPD logged fewer service calls in early June during ICE sweeps

Weekly calls for service

■ 2024 ■ 2025



LAPD

HAILEY WANG Los Angeles Times

Kimmel’s fate tied to media companies

By DAVID BAUDER AND BERNARD CONDON

NEW YORK — The decision about whether to keep Jimmy Kimmel on his late-night ABC show depends on far more than his jokes. The choice is complicated by a web of business and regulatory considerations involv-

ing ABC’s parent company, other media companies and the Trump administration.

It’s the inevitable result of industry consolidation that over years has built giant corporations with wide-ranging interests.

ABC owner Walt Disney Co., a massive organization with far-flung operations, frequently seeks federal

Key facts about Nexstar, Sinclair

The ABC affiliate owners show they have wide influence. **BUSINESS, A9**

regulatory approval to expand, buy or sell businesses or acquire licenses. And the Trump administration has

not spared the company from investigations, opening multiple inquiries in just the last few months to investigate alleged antitrust, programming and hiring violations.

Kimmel was suspended from his show last week following comments suggesting that fans of Charlie Kirk

[See Kimmel, A8]

Fears over Predator drones’ shift from border patrol to L.A. protests

By STEVE FISHER

FT. HUACHUCA, Ariz. — When MQ-9 Predator drones flew over anti-ICE protests in Los Angeles this summer, it was the first time they had been dispatched to monitor demonstrations on U.S. soil since 2020, and their use reflects a change in how the government is choosing to deploy the aircraft once reserved for surveilling the border and war zones.

Previous news reports said the drones sent by the

Department of Homeland Security conducted surveillance on the weekend of June 7 over thousands of protesters demonstrating against raids conducted by Immigration and Customs Enforcement. The Predators flew over Los Angeles for at least four more days, according to tracking experts who identified the flights through air traffic control tower communications and images of a Predator in flight.

Those amateur sleuths, who monitor flight traffic

and identified the first flight, which was confirmed by Customs and Border Protection, shared their findings on social media.

Defenders of using drones to monitor protests say the aircraft, with their high-tech capabilities, can provide authorities useful and detailed information in real time. Human rights advocates fear the new policy will impinge on civil rights.

The drones, which fly at around 20,000 feet to conduct surveillance, can beam

[See Surveillance, A5]



JOHN LOCHER Associated Press

ACTIVIST REMEMBERED

Attendees mourn at a memorial for conservative firebrand Charlie Kirk, whom President Trump called a “great American hero.” **NATION, A4**

Republicans souring on U.S.

The share who see the country as headed in the right direction has fallen sharply, a poll says. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

One collapses, the other gets a lift

Rams squander big lead and lose to Eagles 33-26 while Chargers come back to beat Denver 23-20. **SPORTS, D1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 83/69. **B6**



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